The Noble Eight Names of Vajrapāṇi, Together with the Secret Mantra

Āryavajrapāṇināmāṣṭaka · Toh 950 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་ལག་ན་རྡོ་རྗེའི་མཚན་བརྒྱད་པ་གསང་སྔགས་དང་བཅས་པ།

The Noble Eight Names of Vajrapāṇi, Together with the Secret Mantra, known in Tibetan as Phakpa Lakna Dorjé Tsen Gyepa Sangngak Dang, is a short scripture devoted to the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets and wrathful protector of the Buddha's teaching. It opens with Vajrapāṇi rising before the Blessed One. He explains that he has taught a great rite of supreme knowledge, together with its secrets, and that he now wishes to go to the royal palace of Alakāvatī to tame sentient beings. The Buddha responds by praising Vajrapāṇi's fierce and formidable qualities, which sets the stage for the eight names and the accompanying secret mantra that give the text its title. It is Toh 950 in the Kangyur, where it belongs among the short dhāraṇī and mantra texts associated with the tantric collection.

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Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Then the bodhisattva, the great being Vajrapāṇi, rose from the midst of the assembly. Turning toward where the Blessed One was, he bowed with joined palms and said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, for the sake of sentient beings I have taught the great and extensive rite of the supreme knowledge, together with its secret and its great secret. Blessed One, I wish to go to the royal palace of Alakāvatī and tame sentient beings."

When he had said this, the Blessed One spoke to Vajrapāṇi, Lord of Secrets: "Vajrapāṇi, as for this great and extensive rite of the supreme knowledge that you have taught: you are fierce, you are hard to approach, you are extremely hard to withstand, you are without the manner of the noble ones. Vajrapāṇi, none of the great and extensive rites of the supreme knowledge that you have taught will carry out their work without the secret. Therefore, Vajrapāṇi, so that this vajra family and this great and extensive rite of the supreme knowledge may be accomplished with ease, I shall explain your eight secret names, together with their retinue of secret mantras. When they are heard, even one who has committed the five acts of immediate retribution will be purified of that evil. He will also see you, Vajrapāṇi. All obstructors and

vināyakas will scatter, and the eighty-four hundred thousand koṭis of niyutas of vināyakas will scatter in the ten directions. When they are heard, even one who has not practiced celibacy will become one who has practiced celibacy; even one who has not practiced the discipline of a sage will become one who has practiced it; even one who has not kept the fast will become one who has kept the fast; even one who is not a renunciant (śramaṇa) will come to possess the fruit of a renunciant. All the buddhas and bodhisattvas will protect him, and he will also be granted the accomplishment of ritual actions."

Then the Lord Vajrapāṇi touched his head to the two feet of the Blessed One and said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, what are my eight secret names, together with their retinue of secret mantras?"

The Blessed One said, "Vajrapāṇi, I shall explain; listen! They are these: You are Elephant-Eared. You are Adorned with Fine Ornaments. You are the Subjugator. You are the Source of Jewels. You are the very Cloud of Truth. You are Adorned with Lovely Form. You are Endowed with Blazing Flames. You are Beautiful of Form.

"If the wise hear these names of yours, then for seven hundred thousand koṭis of niyutas of eons those beings will not be born in hell. At the time of death, all the buddhas and bodhisattvas will be present before such a person, and they will teach him the Dharma. Through that teaching of the Dharma he will be born among the gods of Tuṣita heaven, and he will dwell together with the bodhisattvas, the great beings.

namo buddhasya namo dharmasya namaḥ saṃghasya namo vajrapāṇisya tadyathā aṭṭe maṭṭe kharaṭṭe some somā sukhi hiri hiri miri kiri bhibhi bisani siddhantu sarvakāryāṇi sādhaya mantrapada svāhā"

Then the bodhisattva, the great being Vajrapāṇi, said to the Blessed One, "Excellent, Blessed One, excellent! This great secret that you have thus spoken is excellent. Blessed One, it is excellent indeed, excellent indeed! Blessed One, in accomplishing the supreme knowledge, when doing the recitation and at the time of practice, one should make offerings and recite the eight names. When they are recited, I am praised, and being pleased, I wish to grant accomplishments. Obstructors will not arise, and the deities too, being pleased, will swiftly grant accomplishments. If one recites them when going to sleep, one will not see bad dreams. If one recites them a hundred thousand times before a stupa that contains relics, one will be freed from all evil. Even one who has committed the five acts of immediate retribution will become a

bodhisattva in the Fortunate Eon. This I declare. Moreover, if one recites them a hundred thousand times, one will become a master."

The Eight Names of Vajrapāṇi, Together with the Secret Mantra, is complete.

Translator's Notes

• The eight names are rendered by their meaning, since their Sanskrit originals cannot be securely reconstructed from the Tibetan alone (the first may reflect Gajakarṇa, the fourth Ratnākara). The palace name □□□□□□□□□ is rendered Alakāvatī, the usual Sanskrit equivalent and the traditional abode of Vajrapāṇi. "Practiced the discipline of a sage" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□, whose exact technical sense here is uncertain (possibly "austerity"). The text calls Vajrapāṇi □□□□□□□□□□□□ ("blessed one") in one sentence; this is rendered "the Lord Vajrapāṇi."

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.